

founder supplied explanations—mainly that this was caused by an inadvertent software bug—a concern many still hold is that the Dash team misled new investors.²⁰ As of March 2017, those first 24 hours still account for nearly 30 percent of the coins outstanding.

This is a situation in which the innovative investor must discern the difference between a misleading issuer and an honest mistake. We believe that Dash’s initial distribution could have been corrected, just as its competing anonymity cryptoasset, Monero, did, when it was forked off from Bytecoin to solve for an unfair distribution of coins. The Dash team could have relaunched to ensure a fair initial distribution. That said, Dash has worked to overcome its rocky beginning and at the start of April 2017 was one of the top four cryptoassets in network value.²¹ The asset is backed by a few interesting innovations, and its team has successfully navigated to a position of increasing mainstream acceptance.

Misleading statements don’t even have to come from the progenitors of cryptoassets; they can come from people who claim to manage the assets for investors. We have seen many deceptive investment offerings that purport to take investors’ money and place it into cryptoasset funds that will provide “guaranteed” returns. For example, there’s a “Bitcoin Mutual Fund” website that promises to provide 700 percent returns over a range of periods, from 2 hours to 48 hours, depending on the amount of money invested.²² The website is full of